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Resin composition quality controlling method, cable and tube quality controlling method, determination device, inspection system, and cable and tube

Abstract

A resin composition quality controlling method includes a step of measuring a Raman spectrum of a resin composition composed of TiO.sub.2 particles dispersed in a base material mainly composed of a silicone rubber by irradiating the resin composition with laser, and a step of determining a concentration of the TiO.sub.2 particles in the resin composition based on an intensity of a fluorescence spectrum in the Raman spectrum.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS

(1) The present patent application claims the priority of Japanese patent application No. 2021-151927 filed on Sep. 17, 2021, and the entire contents thereof are hereby incorporated by reference.

TECHNICAL FIELD

(2) The present invention relates to a resin composition quality controlling method, a cable and

tube quality controlling method, a determination device, an inspection system, and a cable or a tube.

BACKGROUND ART

(3) A cable for a medical device, which includes a sheath comprising a material blended with an infrared absorbing agent such as titanium dioxide (TiO₂), has been conventionally known (see Patent Literature 1). According to Patent Literature 1, adding the infrared absorbing agent to the sheath allows a coating film on the sheath to be heated also from the sheath side and curing of a portion of the coating film on the sheath side to be accelerated at the time of heating the coating film with infrared rays. The adhesion strength between the coating film and the sheath is thereby improved.

CITATION LIST

Patent Literature

(4) Patent Literature 1: Japanese Patent No. 6723489

SUMMARY OF INVENTION

(5) In recent years, sterilization by irradiation with ultraviolet light in the UV-C region (UV-C light), which allows for simple, inexpensive, and reliable sterilization, has attracted attention as a method for sterilizing cables and tubes for medical devices, but to perform sterilization by irradiation with UV-C light, the resistance of cables and tubes to UV-C light becomes a problem. It is known that when deterioration due to irradiation with UV-C light progresses, cracks occur in an insulator at the time of, e.g., bending cables or tubes. For this reason, a resin composition with excellent resistance to UV-C light are desired to be used as insulators of cables or tubes.

(6) Therefore, it is an object of the invention to provide a resin composition quality controlling method for a resin composition including TiO₂ added as an ultraviolet light shielding material to provide a resin composition having excellent resistance to UV-C light and in which a decrease in percent elongation and quality is suppressed, a determination device and an inspection system which can be used for the method for controlling quality of such a resin composition, a cable and tube quality controlling method for a cable or a tube each including, as an insulator, a resin composition including TiO₂ added as an ultraviolet light shielding material to provide a cable and a tube each having excellent resistance to UV-C light and in which a decrease in percent elongation and quality of the insulator is suppressed, and a cable and a tube each of which includes, as an insulator, a resin composition including TiO₂ added as an ultraviolet light shielding material and has excellent resistance to UV-C light and in which a decrease in percent elongation and quality of the insulator is suppressed.

(7) So as to achieve the above object, one aspect of the invention provides: a resin composition quality controlling method, comprising: measuring a Raman spectrum of a resin composition comprising TiO₂ particles dispersed in a base material comprising mainly a silicone rubber by irradiating the resin composition with laser; and determining a concentration of the TiO₂ particles in the resin composition based on an intensity of a fluorescence spectrum in the Raman spectrum.

(8) So as to achieve the above object, another aspect of the invention provides: a cable and tube quality controlling method, comprising: determining a concentration of the TiO₂ particles in an insulator being provided on a cable or a tube and comprising the resin composition by the resin composition quality controlling method.

(9) So as to achieve the above object, still another aspect of the invention provides: a determination device configured to perform the determining in the resin composition quality controlling method.

(10) So as to achieve the above object, a further aspect of the invention provides: an inspection system, comprising: a Raman measurement device configured to perform the measuring in the resin composition quality controlling method according to claim 1; and a determination device configured to perform the determining in the resin composition quality controlling method according to claim 1.

(11) So as to achieve the above object, a still further aspect of the invention provides: a cable and a tube each comprising: an insulator comprising a resin composition comprising TiO₂ particles dispersed in a base material comprising mainly a silicone rubber, wherein a concentration of the TiO₂ particles in the insulator is within a range of 3.4 to 8.1 mass %.

Effects of the Invention

(12) According to the present invention, it is possible to provide a resin composition quality controlling method for a resin composition including TiO₂ added as an ultraviolet light shielding material to provide a resin composition having excellent resistance to UV-C light and in which a decrease in percent elongation and quality is suppressed, a determination device and an inspection system which can be used for the method for controlling quality of such a resin composition, a cable and tube quality controlling method for a cable or a tube each including, as an insulator, a resin composition including TiO₂ added as an ultraviolet light shielding material to provide a cable and a tube each having excellent resistance to UV-C light and in which a decrease in percent elongation and quality of the insulator is suppressed, and a cable and a tube each of which includes, as an insulator, a resin composition including TiO₂ added as an ultraviolet light shielding material and has excellent resistance to UV-C light and in which a decrease in percent elongation and quality of the insulator is suppressed.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF DRAWINGS

(1) FIG. 1A is a vertical cross-sectional view showing a resin composition according to the first embodiment of the present invention.

(2) FIG. 1B is a vertical cross-sectional view showing two stacked resin compositions in the first embodiment of the invention.

(3) FIG. 2A shows Raman spectra of a resin composition including rutile type TiO₂ particles.

(4) FIG. 2B shows Raman spectra of a resin composition including anatase type TiO₂ particles.

(5) FIG. 2C shows Raman spectra of a resin composition stacked on a resin composition 1a including anatase type TiO₂ particles and irregularity-forming particles.

(6) FIG. 3A is a graph showing a relationship between the integral intensity of the fluorescence spectrum in the Raman spectra of the resin composition shown in FIG. 2A and a concentration of TiO₂ particles in the resin composition.

(7) FIG. 3B is a graph showing a relationship between the integral intensity of the fluorescence spectrum in the Raman spectra of the resin composition shown in FIG. 2B and the concentration of TiO₂ particles in the resin composition.

(8) FIGS. 4A and 4B are graphs showing a relationship between the integral intensity of the fluorescence spectrum in the Raman spectra of the resin composition shown in FIG. 2C and the concentration of TiO₂ particles in the resin composition.

(9) FIG. 5A is a graph showing a relationship between the peak height of the fluorescence spectrum in the Raman spectra of the resin composition shown in FIG. 2A and the concentration of TiO₂ particles in the resin composition.

(10) FIG. 5B is a graph showing a relationship between the peak height of the fluorescence spectrum in the Raman spectra of the resin composition shown in FIG. 2B and the concentration of TiO₂ particles in the resin composition.

(11) FIGS. 6A and 6B are graphs showing a relationship between the peak height of the fluorescence spectrum in the Raman spectra of the resin composition shown in FIG. 2C and the concentration of TiO₂ particles in the resin composition.

(12) FIG. 7A is a graph showing a relationship between the integral intensity ratio in the Raman

spectra of the resin composition shown in FIG. 2A and the concentration of TiO₂ particles in the resin composition.

(13) FIG. 7B is a graph showing a relationship between the integral intensity ratio in the Raman spectra of the resin composition shown in FIG. 2B and the concentration of TiO₂ particles in the resin composition.

(14) FIGS. 8A and 8B are graphs showing a relationship between the integral intensity ratio in the Raman spectra of the resin composition shown in FIG. 2C and the concentration of TiO₂ particles in the resin composition.

(15) FIG. 9A is a graph showing a relationship between the peak height ratio in the Raman spectra of the resin composition shown in FIG. 2A and the concentration of TiO₂ particles in the resin composition.

(16) FIG. 9B is a graph showing a relationship between the peak height ratio in the Raman spectra of the resin composition shown in FIG. 2B and the concentration of TiO₂ particles in the resin composition.

(17) FIGS. 10A and 10B are graphs showing a relationship between the peak height ratio in the Raman spectra of the resin composition shown in FIG. 2C and the concentration of TiO₂ particles in the resin composition.

(18) FIG. 11 is a schematic plan view showing a configuration of an ultrasonic probe cable in the second embodiment of the invention.

(19) FIG. 12A is a radial cross-sectional view showing a cable of the ultrasonic probe cable.

(20) FIG. 12B is a radial cross-sectional view showing the ultrasonic probe cable taken along line A-A shown in FIG. 11.

(21) FIGS. 13A to 13C are radial cross-sectional views, respectively showing medical tubes in the second embodiment of the invention.

(22) FIGS. 14A and 14B are schematic side and top views showing a configuration example of a cable inspection system used for a method for controlling the quality of a cable.

(23) FIG. 15 is a schematic diagram illustrating a probe portion of a Raman measurement device that includes a circumference measuring unit.

DESCRIPTION OF EMBODIMENTS

First Embodiment

Configuration of Resin Composition

(24) FIG. 1A is a vertical cross-sectional view showing a resin composition 1a in the first embodiment of the invention. The resin composition 1a includes a base material 10a made of silicone rubber, and TiO₂ particles 11a included in the base material 10a.

(25) FIG. 1B is a vertical cross-sectional view showing the resin composition 1a and resin composition 1b in the first embodiment of the invention, which are stacked. The resin composition 1b includes a base material 10b made of silicone rubber, TiO₂ particles 11b included in the base material 10b, and irregularity-forming particles 12 such as silicone resin particles to form irregularity (i.e., unevenness) on a surface to improve sliding properties.

(26) The TiO₂ particles 11a, 11b as an ultraviolet light shielding material to shield UV-C light by absorption and/or scattering are added to the resin compositions 1a, 1b, respectively. TiO₂ has a higher scattering coefficient for ultraviolet light than white pigment ZnO or silicone resin and has an excellent ultraviolet light shielding function. A particle diameter of the TiO₂ particles 11a, 11b is, e.g., 10 to 500 nm.

(27) The TiO₂ particles 11a, 11b may be either anatase type TiO₂ particles or rutile type TiO₂ particles, or may include both. Anatase type TiO₂ has a higher absorbance of ultraviolet light in the UV-C region (200 to 280 nm) than rutile type TiO₂. Meanwhile, rutile type TiO₂ can absorb longer wavelength ultraviolet light, as compared to anatase type TiO₂ (rutile type TiO₂ can absorb ultraviolet light at about not more than 400 nm, while anatase type TiO₂ can absorb ultraviolet light at about not more than 370 nm). When the

TiO.sub.2 particles **11a**, **11b** include both anatase type TiO.sub.2 particles and rutile type TiO.sub.2 particles, the resin compositions **1a**, **1b** have excellent resistance to UV-C light and also have resistance to ultraviolet light in a wide wavelength range.

(28) The base materials **10a**, **10b** are made of silicone rubber, as described above. When the resin compositions **1a**, **1b** are used as cable insulator (e.g., a sheath and a coating film thereon), common compounding agents such as various cross-linking agents, cross-linking catalysts, antioxidants, plasticizers, lubricants, fillers, flame retardants, stabilizers, and colorants may be added to the base materials **10a**, **10b**.

(29) The resin composition **1a**, which includes the TiO.sub.2 particles **11a** and has excellent resistance to UV-C light, is suitably used as, e.g., an insulator of a cable or a tube. The resin composition **1a** and the resin composition **1b** stacked thereon are shown in FIG. 1B are, e.g., respectively used as a sheath and a coating film thereon, which are insulators of a cable.

(30) The resin compositions **1a**, **1b** can be in various forms depending on their intended use.

(31) The resin compositions **1a**, **1b** are molded into, e.g., a tube shape when used as an insulator of a cable or a tube, and are molded into a sheet shape when used as a highly UV-resistant sheet for constant temperature house or an ultraviolet shielding sheet (ultraviolet shielding curtain) to shield against ultraviolet light leakage from a sterilization chamber, etc.

Method for Controlling the Quality of Resin Composition

(32) In the resin composition quality controlling method in the first embodiment, a concentration of the TiO.sub.2 particles **11a** in the resin composition **1a** or a concentration of the TiO.sub.2 particles **11b** in the resin composition **1b** can be measured by Raman scattering measurement in a non-destructive, non-contact manner while maintaining the original shape of the resin compositions **1a**, **1b**.

(33) The resin composition quality controlling method in the first embodiment includes, e.g., a measurement step of measuring a Raman spectrum of the resin composition (the resin composition **1a** or the resin composition **1b**) including TiO.sub.2 particles dispersed in a base material consisting mainly of silicone rubber by irradiating the resin composition with laser, and a determination step of determining a concentration of the TiO.sub.2 particles in the resin composition based on the intensity of a fluorescence spectrum in the measured Raman spectrum. Here, the intensity of the peak in Raman spectrum in the embodiments means peak height or integral intensity.

(34) The intensity of the fluorescence spectrum in the Raman spectrum varies with the concentration of TiO.sub.2 included in the resin composition. Therefore, based on this intensity of the fluorescence spectrum, it is possible to determine the concentration of the TiO.sub.2 particles in the resin composition **1a** or **1b**.

(35) FIG. 2A shows Raman spectra of the resin composition **1a** including 3 mass %, 6 mass % or 9 mass % of rutile type TiO.sub.2 particles as the TiO.sub.2 particles **11a**. FIG. 2B shows Raman spectra of the resin composition **1a** including 3 mass %, 6 mass % or 9 mass % of anatase type particles as the TiO.sub.2 particles **11a**. FIG. 2C shows Raman spectra of the resin composition **1b** stacked on the resin composition **1a** and including 3 mass %, 6 mass %, 9 mass % or 24 mass % of anatase type TiO.sub.2 particles as the TiO.sub.2 particles **11b**. The resin composition **1b** for FIG. 2C includes silicone resin particles as the irregularity-forming particles **12**.

(36) The Raman scattering measurement to obtain the spectra shown in FIGS. 2A to 2C was performed using RAMANforce Standard VIS-NIR-HS available from Nanophoton Corporation under the following measurement conditions: a wavelength of the laser was 532 nm, a width of an incident slit of a spectrometer was 50 μ m, the number of rulings in a diffraction grating was 300 gr/mm, a value of a ratio of the amount of light after attenuation to the maximum amount of laser light of an ND filter (an attenuation ratio) was 165/255 to 200/255, magnification, numerical aperture (NA) and theoretical measurement diameter of an objective lens were respectively 5 $\times$, 0.15 and 2.2 μ m, a laser scanning range was about 1653 μ m $\times$ 1512 μ m, and counting time was 1

second×10 to 15 cycles. In addition, the Raman scattering measurement was performed in an environment where the temperature was 20° C. (an average value from 2-point measurement in an analysis laboratory), the humidity was 28 RH % (an average value from 3-point measurement in the analysis laboratory), and air pressure was normal pressure (so-called atmospheric pressure).

(37) In the Raman spectra in each of FIGS. 2A to 2C, a high-intensity fluorescence spectrum is observed when the concentration of the TiO.sub.2 particles is 6 mass %. This phenomenon, in which a high-intensity fluorescence spectrum is observed in the Raman spectrum when the concentration of the TiO.sub.2 particles is around 6 mass %, is considered to be characteristic of resin compositions including TiO.sub.2 particles dispersed in silicone rubber, such as the resin compositions 1a and 1b. It is a phenomenon first discovered by the present inventors.

(38) FIG. 3A is a graph showing a relationship between the integral intensity of fluorescence spectrum in the Raman spectra of the resin composition 1a including rutile type TiO.sub.2 particles as the TiO.sub.2 particles 11a shown in FIG. 2A and the concentration of the TiO.sub.2 particles 11a in the resin composition 1a. FIG. 3B is a graph showing a relationship between the integral intensity of fluorescence spectrum in the Raman spectra of the resin composition 1a including anatase type TiO.sub.2 particles as the TiO.sub.2 particles 11a shown in FIG. 2B and the concentration of the TiO.sub.2 particles 11a in the resin composition 1a. FIGS. 4A and 4B are graphs showing a relationship between the integral intensity of fluorescence spectrum in the Raman spectra of the resin composition 1b including anatase type TiO.sub.2 particles as the TiO.sub.2 particles 11b shown in FIG. 2C and the concentration of the TiO.sub.2 particles 11b in the resin composition 1b.

(39) The integral intensity of each fluorescence spectrum was obtained by fitting analysis using the Lorentz distribution function, which is performed by integrating the fluorescence spectrum over a range of 250 to 4250 cm.sup.-1, which includes substantially the entire fluorescence spectrum. In this regard, the fitting analysis can be performed using Gauss distribution function, Lorentz distribution function, Pseudo-Voigt distribution function, or an equation expressed as a superposition of two or more of these functions according to the shape of the spectral pattern.

(40) An approximate curve in FIG. 3A is a curve obtained by polynomial approximation using the least-square method and is expressed by the equation

$y = -4.56 \times 10^{-6} x^2 + 5.31 \times 10^{-7} x - 9.94 \times 10^{-7}$, where x is a value on the horizontal axis and y is a value on the vertical axis. An approximate curve in FIG. 3B is a curve obtained by polynomial approximation using the least-square method and is expressed by the equation $y = -1.53 \times 10^{-6} x^2 + 1.85 \times 10^{-7} x - 3.80 \times 10^{-7}$, where x is a value on the horizontal axis and y is a value on the vertical axis. An approximate curve in FIG. 4A is a curve obtained by polynomial approximation using the least-square method and is expressed by the equation $y = -5.54 \times 10^{-6} x^2 + 6.75 \times 10^{-7} x - 1.50 \times 10^{-8}$, where x is a value on the horizontal axis and y is a value on the vertical axis.

(41) FIG. 5A is a graph showing a relationship between peak height of fluorescence spectrum in the Raman spectra of the resin composition 1a including rutile type TiO.sub.2 particles as the TiO.sub.2 particles 11a shown in FIG. 2A and the concentration of TiO.sub.2 particles 11a in the resin composition 1a. FIG. 5B is a graph showing a relationship between peak height of fluorescence spectrum in the Raman spectra of the resin composition 1a including anatase type TiO.sub.2 particles as the TiO.sub.2 particles 11a shown in FIG. 2B and the concentration of TiO.sub.2 particles 11a in the resin composition 1a. FIGS. 6A and 6B are graphs showing a relationship between peak height of fluorescence spectrum in the Raman spectra of the resin composition 1b including anatase type TiO.sub.2 particles as the TiO.sub.2 particles 11b shown in FIG. 2C and the concentration of TiO.sub.2 particles 11b in the resin composition 1b.

(42) The peak height of each fluorescence spectrum was obtained by subtracting the intensity of a baseline, which is a straight line connecting a point at 250 cm.sup.-1 and a point at 4250 cm.sup.-1 on the fluorescence spectrum, from the highest intensity of the fluorescence spectrum observed

in the range of 250 to 4250 cm^{sup.}−1. Here, the highest fluorescence spectrum intensity shown in FIG. 2A is the intensity at 575.4 nm (at a Raman shift of 1415.7 cm^{sup.}−1) indicated by an arrow, the highest Raman spectrum intensity shown in FIG. 2B is the intensity at 564.2 nm (at a Raman shift of 1070.7 cm^{sup.}−1) indicated by an arrow, and the highest Raman spectrum intensity shown in FIG. 2C is the intensity at 548.5 nm (at a Raman shift of 563.3 cm^{sup.}−1) indicated by an arrow.

(43) An approximate curve in FIG. 5A is a curve obtained by polynomial approximation using the least-square method and is expressed by the equation

$y = -2.0088 \times 10^{-3} x^2 + 2.3683 \times 10^{-4} x - 4.0506 \times 10^{-4}$, where x is a value on the horizontal axis and y is a value on the vertical axis. An approximate curve in FIG. 5B is a curve obtained by polynomial approximation using the least-square method and is expressed by the equation $y = -8.20844 \times 10^{-2} x^2 + 9.85013 \times 10^{-3} x - 1.94984 \times 10^{-4}$, where x is a value on the horizontal axis and y is a value on the vertical axis. An approximate curve in FIG. 6A is a curve obtained by polynomial approximation using the least-square method and is expressed by the equation $y = -3.69234 \times 10^{-3} x^2 + 4.47697 \times 10^{-4} x - 9.83856 \times 10^{-5}$, where x is a value on the horizontal axis and y is a value on the vertical axis.

(44) The graphs in FIGS. 3A, 3B, 4A, 4B, 5A, 5B, 6A, and 6B show that fluorescence intensity is extremely high only when the concentration of the TiO₂ particles in the resin composition including silicon rubber as a base material is near 6 mass % regardless of whether the TiO₂ particles are rutile type or anatase type. Therefore, when the fluorescence spectrum has a certain degree of intensity, it can be determined that the concentration of the TiO₂ particles is near 6 mass %, e.g., at least within a range of 3.4 to 8.1 mass %, even if the exact intensity of the fluorescence spectrum is unknown. In other words, the intensity of the fluorescence spectrum is high enough to be easily determined when the concentration of the TiO₂ particles is at least within the range of 3.4 to 8.1 mass %.

(45) Regarding this range of 3.4 to 8.1 mass %, a mean value μ and a standard deviation σ between two points with intensity (integral intensity, peak intensity) of the fluorescence spectrum of 0 were calculated for each of the approximate curves (quadratic curves) in FIGS. 3A, 3B, 4A, 5A, 5B, and 6A and the range of 3.4 to 8.1 mass % was determined as a range including all the obtained ranges of $\mu \pm \sigma$ (rounded down to the nearest tenth to obtain the minimum value, 3.4, and rounded up to the nearest tenth to obtain the maximum value, 8.1). In particular, the range of $\mu \pm \sigma$ obtained from the approximate curve in FIG. 3A was 3.4 to 8.1 mass %, the range of $\mu \pm \sigma$ obtained from the approximate curve in FIG. 3B was 3.9 to 8.0 mass %, the range of $\mu \pm \sigma$ obtained from the approximate curve in FIG. 4A was 4.2 to 7.9 mass %, the range of $\mu \pm \sigma$ obtained from the approximate curve in FIG. 5A was 3.6 to 7.8 mass %, the range of $\mu \pm \sigma$ obtained from the approximate curve in FIG. 5B was 4.0 to 8.1 mass %, the range of $\mu \pm \sigma$ obtained from the approximate curve in FIG. 6A was 4.0 to 8.0 mass %, and 3.4 to 8.1 was obtained as the range including all of these.

(46) Here, the higher the concentration of the TiO₂ particles in the resin composition, the more effectively the TiO₂ particles shield UV-C light and the higher the resistance of the resin composition to UV-C light, but it has been confirmed that the resistance of the resin composition to UV-C light is sufficient when at least not less than 3.4 mass %. Meanwhile, when the concentration of the TiO₂ particles in the resin composition is too high, percent elongation of the resin composition decreases, or the TiO₂ particles may not be uniformly dispersed due to aggregation, etc., but it has been confirmed that such problems do not occur when at least not more than 8.1 mass %. That is, when the concentration of the TiO₂ particles in the resin composition including silicon rubber as a base material is within the range of 3.4 to 8.1 mass %, the resistance of the resin composition to UV-C light can be increased while suppressing a decrease in percent elongation or quality.

(47) Meanwhile, in each of the Raman spectra in FIGS. 2A to 2C, e.g., a peak assigned to C—H

stretching vibration originating from silicone included in the base materials **10a**, **10b** (hereinafter, referred to as C—H stretching vibration peak) can be used as a standard for intensity (integral intensity, peak intensity) of the fluorescence spectrum. That is, it is possible to evaluate the characteristics of the resin composition described above based on values of ratios of integral intensity/peak height of fluorescence spectrum to integral intensity/peak height of the C—H stretching vibration peak in the Raman spectrum. Two peaks exhibiting the highest intensity in a range of 2800 to 3100 cm.^{sup.}−1 are the C—H stretching vibration peaks. The integral intensity of the C—H stretching vibration peak is a sum of the integral intensities of these two peaks, and the peak height of the C—H stretching vibration peak is the height of the peak of the two which is located on the low wavenumber side (the left side in FIG. 2). The integral intensity and peak height of the C—H stretching vibration peak are calculated by fitting analysis using a statistical distribution function such as Lorentz function, Pseudo-Voigt function, or Gauss distribution function.

(48) FIG. 7A is a graph showing a relationship between a value of a ratio of the integral intensity of the fluorescence spectrum to the integral intensity of the C—H stretching vibration peak (an integral intensity ratio) in the Raman spectra of the resin composition **1a** including rutile type TiO.sub.2 particles as the TiO.sub.2 particles **11a** shown in FIG. 2A and the concentration of the TiO.sub.2 particles **11a** in the resin composition **1a**. FIG. 7B is a graph showing a relationship between a value of the ratio of the integral intensity of the fluorescence spectrum to the integral intensity of the C—H stretching vibration peak (the integral intensity ratio) in the Raman spectra of the resin composition **1a** including anatase type TiO.sub.2 particles as the TiO.sub.2 particles **11a** shown in FIG. 2B and the concentration of the TiO.sub.2 particles **11a** in the resin composition **1a**. FIGS. 8A and 8B are graphs showing a relationship between a value of the ratio of the integral intensity of the fluorescence spectrum to the integral intensity of the C—H stretching vibration peak (the integral intensity ratio) in the Raman spectra of the resin composition **1b** including anatase type TiO.sub.2 particles as the TiO.sub.2 particles **11b** shown in FIG. 2C and the concentration of the TiO.sub.2 particles **11b** in the resin composition **1b**.

(49) An approximate curve in FIG. 7A is a curve obtained by polynomial approximation using the least-square method and is expressed by the equation $y = -4.30141x^{sup.2} + 4.93110 \times 10x - 8.66383 \times 10$, where x is a value on the horizontal axis and y is a value on the vertical axis. An approximate curve in FIG. 7B is a curve obtained by polynomial approximation using the least-square method and is expressed by the equation $y = -7.19385x^{sup.2} + 8.67671 \times 10x - 1.75336 \times 10^{sup.2}$, where x is a value on the horizontal axis and y is a value on the vertical axis. An approximate curve in FIG. 8A is a curve obtained by polynomial approximation using the least-square method and is expressed by the equation $y = -3.03490 \times 10x^{sup.2} + 3.69587 \times 10^{sup.2}x - 8.23155 \times 10^{sup.2}$, where x is a value on the horizontal axis and y is a value on the vertical axis.

(50) FIG. 9A is a graph showing a relationship between a value of a ratio of peak height of the fluorescence spectrum to peak height of the C—H stretching vibration peak (a peak height ratio) in the Raman spectra of the resin composition **1a** including rutile type TiO.sub.2 particles as the TiO.sub.2 particles **11a** shown in FIG. 2A and the concentration of the TiO.sub.2 particles **11a** in the resin composition **1a**. FIG. 9B is a graph showing a relationship between a value of the ratio of the peak height of the fluorescence spectrum to the peak height of the C—H stretching vibration peak (the peak height ratio) in the Raman spectra of the resin composition **1a** including anatase type TiO.sub.2 particles as the TiO.sub.2 particles **11a** shown in FIG. 2B and the concentration of the TiO.sub.2 particles **11a** in the resin composition **1a**. FIGS. 10A and 10B are graphs showing a relationship between a value of the ratio of peak height of the fluorescence spectrum to the peak height of the C—H stretching vibration peak (the peak height ratio) in the Raman spectra of the resin composition **1b** including anatase type TiO.sub.2 particles as the TiO.sub.2 particles **11b** shown in FIG. 2C and the concentration of the TiO.sub.2 particles **11b** in the resin composition **1b**.

(51) An approximate curve in FIG. 9A is a curve obtained by polynomial approximation using the least-square method and is expressed by the equation $y = -8.9909 \times 10^{-2}x^2 + 1.0311x - 1.5594$, where x is a value on the horizontal axis and y is a value on the vertical axis. An approximate curve in FIG. 9B is a curve obtained by polynomial approximation using the least-square method and is expressed by the equation $y = -1.80797 \times 10^{-1}x^2 + 2.15236x - 4.14563$, where x is a value on the horizontal axis and y is a value on the vertical axis. An approximate curve in FIG. 10A is a curve obtained by polynomial approximation using the least-square method and is expressed by the equation $y = -9.01775 \times 10^{-1}x^2 + 1.09429x - 2.40850$, where x is a value on the horizontal axis and y is a value on the vertical axis.

(52) Table 1 below shows the integral intensity ratio and the peak height ratio for each concentration of the TiO₂ particles **11a** (rutile type) in the resin composition **1a** for each plotted point in FIGS. 7A and 9A, and the respective integral intensities and peak heights of the fluorescence spectrum and the C—H stretching vibration peak for each concentration of the TiO₂ particles **11a** (rutile type) in the resin composition **1a** which were used to calculate the ratios. In this regard, the numerical values of the integral intensity and the peak height of the fluorescence spectrum in Table 1 respectively correspond to the plotted points in FIGS. 3A and 5A.

(53) TABLE-US-00001

	Concentration	3	6	9	24	Peak Integral	Peak Integral	Peak intensity	Peak intensity	height intensity	height intensity	ratio	ratio
Fluorescence	3	19030385	12464	842716	17199	22.6	0.72	of TiO ₂	6	55424178	29275	1019250	21054
C—H stretching	3	54.4	1.4	particles	9	9810884	9928	1121593	22671	8.75	0.44	(mass %)	

(54) Table 2 below shows the integral intensity ratio and the peak height ratio for each concentration of the TiO₂ particles **11a** (anatase type) in the resin composition **1a** for each plotted point in FIGS. 7B and 9B, and the respective integral intensities and peak heights of the fluorescence spectrum and the C—H stretching vibration peak for each concentration of the TiO₂ particles **11a** (anatase type) in the resin composition **1a** which were used to calculate the ratios. In this regard, the numerical values of the integral intensity and the peak height of the fluorescence spectrum in Table 2 respectively correspond to the plotted points in FIGS. 3B and 5B.

(55) TABLE-US-00002

	Concentration	3	6	9	24	Peak Integral	Peak Integral	Peak intensity	Peak intensity	height intensity	height intensity	ratio	ratio
Fluorescence	3	3835821	2664	189699	3894	20.2	0.68	of TiO ₂	6	18217533	10052	211125	44484
C—H stretching	3	86.3	2.3	particles	9	5144444	2664	224983	4585	22.9	0.58	(mass %)	

(56) Table 3 below shows the integral intensity ratio and the peak height ratio for each concentration of the TiO₂ particles **11b** (anatase type) in the resin composition **1b** for each plotted point in FIGS. 8A, 8B, 10A and 10B, and the respective integral intensities and peak heights of the fluorescence spectrum and the C—H stretching vibration peak for each concentration of the TiO₂ particles **11b** (anatase type) in the resin composition **1b** which were used to calculate the ratios. In this regard, the numerical values of the integral intensity and the peak height of the fluorescence spectrum in Table 3 respectively correspond to the plotted points in FIGS. 4A, 4B, 6A and 6B.

(57) TABLE-US-00003

	Concentration	3	6	9	24	Peak Integral	Peak Integral	Peak intensity	Peak intensity	height intensity	height intensity	ratio	ratio
Fluorescence	3	2620199	2692	210176	4289	12.5	0.63	of TiO ₂	6	55541541	37308	184030	4096
C—H stretching	3	302	9.1	particles	9	8815947	5462	196499	4023	44.9	1.4	(mass %)	
		3555	31.6	1.3									

(58) Values of the ratios of the integral intensity/the peak height of fluorescence spectrum to the integral intensity/the peak height of the C—H stretching vibration peak (the integral intensity ratio and the peak height ratio) do not change even when intensity of the entire spectrum changes, hence, these values do not depend on measurement conditions such as measurement device or measurement temperature. Therefore, by using the integral intensity ratio or the peak height ratio, it

is possible to determine the concentration of the TiO.sub.2 particles in the resin composition while eliminating the effect of changes in spectral intensity which is dependent on the measurement conditions. Then, for example, it can be determined from FIGS. 7A and 9A that the concentration of rutile type TiO.sub.2 particles included in the resin composition **1a** is within the range of 3.4 to 8.1 mass % (the range including 3.4 to 8.1 mass %, which is the range of $\mu \pm \sigma$ obtained from the approximate curve in FIG. 3A, and 3.6 to 7.8 mass %, which is the range of $\mu \pm \sigma$ obtained from the approximate curve in FIG. 5A) when the integral intensity ratio is not less than 30.5 and the peak height ratio is not less than 0.89, it can be determined from FIGS. 7B and 9B that the concentration of anatase type TiO.sub.2 particles included in the resin composition **1a** is within the range of 3.9 to 8.1 mass % (the range including 3.9 to 8.0 mass %, which is the range of $\mu \pm \sigma$ obtained from the approximate curve in FIG. 3B, and 4.0 to 8.1 mass %, which is the range of $\mu \pm \sigma$ obtained from the approximate curve in FIG. 5B), i.e., within the range of 3.4 to 8.1 mass % when the integral intensity ratio is not less than 36.5 and the peak height ratio is not less than 1.0, and it can be determined from FIGS. 8A and 10A that the concentration of anatase type TiO.sub.2 particles included together with the silicone resin particles in the resin composition **1b** is within the range of 4.0 to 8.0 mass % (the range including 4.2 to 7.9 mass %, which is the range of $\mu \pm \sigma$ obtained from the approximate curve in FIG. 4A, and 4.0 to 8.0 mass %, which is the range of $\mu \pm \sigma$ obtained from the approximate curve in FIG. 6A), i.e., within the range of 3.4 to 8.1 mass % when the integral intensity ratio is not less than 82 and the peak height ratio is not less than 2.6.

(59) In this regard, the reason why the integral intensity ratio in FIG. 8A is extremely higher than the integral intensity ratios in FIGS. 7A, 7B and the peak height ratio in FIG. 10A is extremely higher than the peak height ratios in FIGS. 9A, 9B has not been confirmed, but it is presumed to be due to the silicone resin particles included in the resin composition **1b**. One possible hypothesis is that the presence of silicone resin particles increases the region where high fluorescence intensity derived from titanium oxide occurs since the titanium oxide particles aggregate and become dense at the sites between the silicone resin particles. Actually, an aggregated state of titanium oxide between the silicone resin particles has been confirmed by Raman spectroscopy.

(60) In the Raman scattering measurement in the resin composition quality controlling method in the first embodiment, a spot diameter of laser irradiated onto a surface of the resin compositions **1a**, **1b** is a measuring area, hence, evaluation can be performed within a microscopic region with a diameter of not more than 1 μm (e.g., 0.4 to 1.0 μm). That is, it is possible to obtain not only average information about the concentration of the TiO.sub.2 particles **11a**, **11b** in the resin compositions **1a**, **1b** but also information for each microscopic region, enabling more precise control of the quality of the resin compositions **1a**, **1b**. In this regard, the above-mentioned value is not the limit value for the laser spot diameter. In principle, the laser spot diameter is determined by the wavelength of laser source and the numerical aperture of the objective lens. Therefore, when Raman spectroscopy analysis is performed on the resin compositions **1a**, **1b** by using the laser with a shorter wavelength and an objective lens with a large numerical aperture, it is possible to measure in even smaller microscopic regions of less than 0.4 μm .

(61) In addition, the concentration of the TiO.sub.2 particles in the resin compositions **1a**, **1b** in various forms can be determined by using a gun-type Raman measurement device of which the probe portion including a laser emitting portion and a scattered light receiving portion can be moved freely.

Second Embodiment

(62) The second embodiment of the invention relates to a cable or a tube that includes insulators made of the resin compositions **1a**, **1b** in the first embodiment. Next, an example of such a cable used for a medical ultrasonic probe cable will be described.

(63) FIG. 11 is a schematic plan view showing a configuration of an ultrasonic probe cable **2** in the second embodiment of the invention. As shown in FIG. 11, the ultrasonic probe cable **2** is configured such that an ultrasonic probe **32** is attached to an end portion of a cable **20** via a boot **31**

protecting the end portion. Then, a connector **33** to be connected to a main body of an ultrasonic imaging device is attached to the other end of the cable **20**.

(64) FIG. **12A** is a radial cross-sectional view showing the cable **20** of the ultrasonic probe cable **2**. Inside the cable **20**, e.g., plural electric wires **21** typified by coaxial cable are housed and a shield **22** such as braided shield is provided so as to cover the plural electric wires **21**. Then, a sheath **23** and a coating film **24** thereon are provided so as to cover the shield **22**.

(65) FIG. **12B** is a radial cross-sectional view showing the ultrasonic probe cable **2** taken long line A-A shown in FIG. **11**. As shown in FIG. **12B**, the boot **31** is attached to the coating film **24** via an adhesive layer **34** so as to cover the coating film **24**. The adhesive layer **34** is made of, e.g., a silicone-based adhesive or an epoxy-based adhesive. Meanwhile, the boot **31** may be made of, e.g., PVC, silicone rubber or chloroprene rubber, etc., and preferably includes TiO₂ particles to shield UV-C light or an organic UV light absorbing agent in the same manner as the resin composition **1a**.

(66) The sheath **23** and the coating film **24** of the cable **20** are respectively made of the resin composition **1a** and the resin composition **1b**. That is, the cable **20** includes insulators made of the resin compositions **1a**, **1b** including TiO₂ particles dispersed in a base material consisting mainly of a silicone rubber. Here, by using the resin compositions **1a**, **1b** including the TiO₂ particles **11a**, **11b** with a concentration within the range of 3.4 to 8.1 mass %, it is possible to increase resistance of the cable **20** to UV-C light while suppressing a decrease in percent elongation or quality of the insulators. In addition, since the coating film **24** made of the resin composition **1b** includes the irregularity-forming particles **12** and has surface irregularity, the cable **20** is excellent in sliding properties. The TiO₂ particles **11a**, **11b** in the sheath **23** and the coating film **24** are not shown in the drawings.

(67) Even when the cable **20** does not include the coating film **24**, it is possible to increase resistance of the cable **20** to UV-C light while suppressing a decrease in percent elongation or quality of the insulators when the resin composition **1a**, which includes the TiO₂ particles **11a**, with a concentration within the range of 3.4 to 8.1 mass %, is used as a material of the sheath **23**.

(68) Next, an example of a method for manufacturing the ultrasonic probe cable **2** in the second embodiment will be described. Firstly, plural (e.g., not less than one hundred) electric wires **21** are bundled together. Then, the shield **22** is formed to cover the bundled plural electric wires **21**. Subsequently, the sheath **23** made of resin composition **1a** and the coating film made of resin composition **1b** are formed to cover the shield **22**. The sheath **23** is formed by, e.g., extrusion using an extruder. The coating film **24** is formed by, e.g., a dipping method, a spray coating method, a roll coating method.

(69) Next, a configuration of a tube (a hollow tube) used for medical applications such as catheter will be described as another example of the cable and tube including insulators made of the resin compositions **1a**, **1b**.

(70) FIGS. **13A** to **13C** are radial cross-sectional views respectively showing medical tubes in the second embodiment of the invention. A medical tube **40a** shown in FIG. **13A** includes an outer coating film **42** on an outer surface **41a** of a tube main body **41**. A medical tube **40b** shown in FIG. **13B** includes an inner coating film **43** on an inner surface **41b** of the tube main body **41**. A medical tube **40c** shown in FIG. **13C** includes the outer coating film **42** and the inner coating film **43** respectively on the outer surface **41a** and the inner surface **41b** of the tube main body **41**.

(71) As exemplified as the medical tubes **40a**, **40b**, **40c**, the tube in the second embodiment includes the tube main body **41**, and the outer coating film **42** coating film the outer surface **41a** of the tube main body **41**, or the inner coating film **43** coating film the inner surface **41b** of the tube main body **41**, or both the outer coating film **42** and the inner coating film **43**.

(72) The medical tubes **40a**, **40b**, **40c** are configured such that the tube main body **41** is made of resin composition **1a**, and the outer coating film **42** and the inner coating film **43** are made of the resin composition **1b**. That is, the medical tubes **40a**, **40b**, **40c** include insulators made of the resin

compositions **1a**, **1b** including the TiO.sub.2 particles **11a**, **11b** dispersed in a base material consisting mainly of silicone rubber. Here, by using the resin compositions **1a**, **1b** including the TiO.sub.2 particles **11a**, **11b** with a concentration within the range of 3.4 to 8.1 mass %, it is possible to increase the resistance of the medical tube **40a**, **40b**, **40c** to UV-C light while suppressing a decrease in percent elongation or quality. In addition, since the outer coating film **42** and the inner coating film **43** made of the resin composition **1b** include the irregularity-forming particles **12** and have surface irregularity, the surfaces of the outer coating film **42** and the inner coating film **43** of the medical tubes **40a**, **40b**, **40c** are excellent in sliding properties. The TiO.sub.2 particles **11a**, **11b** in the tube main body **41**, the outer coating film **42**, and the inner coating film **43** are not shown in the drawings.

(73) The tube in the second embodiment can be used for, e.g., a tube set for an endoscopic surgical instrument, a tube set for an ultrasonic surgical instrument, a tube for blood analyzer, piping in an oxygen concentrator, a dialysis blood circuit, an artificial cardiopulmonary circuit, and an endotracheal tube, etc.

(74) Even when the medical tubes **40a**, **40b**, **40c** do not include the outer coating film **42** and the inner coating film **43**, it is possible to increase the resistance of the medical tubes **40a**, **40b**, **40c** to UV-C light while suppressing a decrease in percent elongation or quality when the resin composition **1a**, which includes the TiO.sub.2 particles **11a** with a concentration within the range of 3.4 to 8.1 mass %, is used as a material of the tube main body **41**.

Method for Controlling the Quality of Cable or Tube

(75) According to the second embodiment, as a cable and tube quality controlling method with insulators made of the resin compositions **1a**, **1b**, it is possible to provide a cable and tube quality controlling method, in which the concentration of the TiO.sub.2 particles in an insulator being provided on a cable or a tube and made of the resin composition **1a** or the resin composition **1b** is determined using the resin composition quality controlling method described above.

(76) FIGS. **14A** and **14B** are schematic side and top views showing a configuration example of a cable inspection system **50** used for a method for controlling the quality of a cable. The cable inspection system **50** is capable of inspecting a cable **70** including an insulator (or insulators) made of a resin composition including TiO.sub.2 particles dispersed in a base material consisting mainly of silicone rubber, such as the cable **20** described above, and capable of determining the concentration of the TiO.sub.2 particles in the insulator.

(77) The cable inspection system **50** includes an introduction reel **51** to introduce the cable **70** into the cable inspection system **50**, a sending reel **52** to send out the cable **70** introduced by the introduction reel **51** to the measuring area for Raman scattering measurement, a receiving reel **53** to receive the cable **70** which passed through the measuring area, a wind-up coil **54** to wind up the cable **70** received by the receiving reel **53**, a sending guide jig **55** placed between the introduction reel **51** and the sending reel **52** to guide advance of the cable **70**, a receiving guide jig **56** placed between the receiving reel **53** and the wind-up coil **54** to guide advance of the cable **70**, a support **57** to support the sending reel **52** and the receiving reel **53**, etc., and a Raman measurement device **58** to perform measurement on the insulator of the cable **70** in the measuring area between the sending reel **52** and the receiving reel **53**.

(78) Regarding the Raman measurement device **58**, only a probe portion thereof is schematically shown in FIGS. **14A** and **14B**. The probe portion of the Raman measurement device **58** has an objective lens **59** that focuses laser light **L** to the insulator of the cable **70**.

(79) With the cable inspection system **50**, it is possible to determine the concentration of TiO.sub.2 particles in the insulator(s) in the original state of the cable **70** without destroying the cable **70**.

(80) The probe portion of the Raman measurement device **58** may include a circumference measuring unit **60** which has plural objective lenses **59** arranged to surround the cable **70**, as shown in FIG. **15**. Raman scattering measurement can be performed over the entire circumference of the cable **70** by using the circumference measuring unit **60**. Alternatively, the circumference measuring

unit **60** may have a structure to perform Raman scattering measurement over the entire circumference of the cable **70** by moving one objective lens **59** along the circumferential direction of the cable **70**. In addition, the Raman measurement device **58** may be a gun-type Raman measurement device of which the probe portion can be moved freely.

(81) The Raman measurement device **58** may be connected to a determination device that determines the concentration of the TiO.sub.2 particles in the insulator(s) of the cable **70** based on the intensity of the fluorescence spectrum in the Raman spectrum. This determination device is, e.g., a personal computer with a program to perform the above-mentioned determination stored in storage. This determination device can be also used for quality control of resin compositions such as the resin compositions **1a**, **1b** in a form other than the insulator of the cable **70**. That is, according to the invention, it is possible to provide a determination device capable of performing the above-described determination step in the method for controlling the quality of the resin composition.

(82) The Raman measurement device **58** also can perform the measurement step by Raman scattering measurement in the method for controlling the quality of the cable in the second embodiment. The Raman measurement device **58** can be also used for the measurement of resin compositions such as the resin compositions **1a**, **1b** in a form other than the insulators of the cable **70**. That is, according to the invention, it is possible to provide an inspection system that includes the Raman measurement device **58** capable of performing the above-described measurement step in the method for controlling the quality of the resin composition, and the determination device capable of performing the above-described determination step in the method for controlling the quality of the resin composition.

Effects of the Embodiments

(83) According to the first embodiment, the concentration of the TiO.sub.2 particles in the resin composition can be determined using Raman scattering measurement, to provide a resin composition having excellent resistance to UV-C light and in which a decrease in percent elongation and quality is suppressed.

(84) According to the second embodiment, it is possible to provide a cable or a tube that includes insulators made of resin compositions including TiO.sub.2 particles dispersed in a base material consisting mainly of silicone rubber and configured to have a TiO.sub.2 particle concentration within the range of 3.4 to 8.1 mass % and has excellent resistance to UV-C light and in which a decrease in percent elongation and quality of the insulators is suppressed. In addition, according to the second embodiment, the concentration of the TiO.sub.2 particles in the insulators of the cable or the tube can be determined using Raman scattering measurement, to provide a cable or a tube which has excellent resistance to UV-C light and in which a decrease in percent elongation and quality of the insulators is suppressed.

(85) In addition, the resin composition quality controlling method, the cable and tube quality controlling method, and the determination device and the inspection system used in the cable and tube quality controlling method, etc., according to the embodiments described above can be also applied to material development using Materials Informatics (MI) which uses machine learning or artificial intelligence (AI), etc., to analyze data.

SUMMARY OF THE EMBODIMENTS

(86) Technical ideas understood from the embodiments will be described below citing the reference signs, etc., used for the embodiments. However, each reference sign, etc., described below is not intended to limit the constituent elements in the claims to the members, etc., specifically described in the embodiments.

(87) According to the feature [1], a resin composition quality controlling method includes: measuring a Raman spectrum of a resin composition **1a**, **1b** comprising TiO.sub.2 particles **11a**, **11b** dispersed in a base material **10a**, **10b** comprising mainly a silicone rubber by irradiating the resin composition **1a**, **1b** with laser; and determining a concentration of the TiO.sub.2 particles **11a**,

11b in the resin composition **1a**, **1b** based on the intensity of a fluorescence spectrum in the Raman spectrum.

(88) According to the feature [2], in the resin composition quality controlling method defined by the feature [1], in the determining, determination of whether or not the concentration of the TiO.sub.2 particles **11a**, **11b** in the resin composition **1a**, **1b** is within a range of 3.4 to 8.1 mass % is made.

(89) According to the feature [3], in the resin composition quality controlling method defined by the feature [2], in the determining, the determination is made based on a value of a ratio of the intensity of the fluorescence spectrum to an intensity of a peak assigned to C—H stretching vibration in the Raman spectrum.

(90) According to the feature [4], in the resin composition quality controlling method defined by the feature [3], in the determining, the determination is made based on whether or not a value of a ratio of an integral intensity of the fluorescence spectrum to an integral intensity of the peak assigned to C—H stretching vibration in the Raman spectrum is not less than 30.5 when the TiO.sub.2 particles are rutile type.

(91) According to the feature [5], in the resin composition quality controlling method defined by the feature [3], in the determining, the determination is made based on whether or not a value of a ratio of a peak height of the fluorescence spectrum to a peak height of the peak assigned to C—H stretching vibration in the Raman spectrum is not less than 0.89 when the TiO.sub.2 particles are rutile type.

(92) According to the feature [6], in the resin composition quality controlling method defined by the feature [3], in the determining, the determination is made based on whether or not the value of the ratio of the integral intensity of the fluorescence spectrum to the integral intensity of the peak assigned to C—H stretching vibration in the Raman spectrum is not less than 36.5 when the TiO.sub.2 particles are anatase type.

(93) According to the feature [7], in the resin composition quality controlling method defined by the feature [3], in the determining, the determination is made based on whether or not the value of the ratio of the peak height of the fluorescence spectrum to the peak height of the peak assigned to C—H stretching vibration in the Raman spectrum is not less than 1.0 when the TiO.sub.2 particles are anatase type.

(94) According to the feature [8], in the resin composition quality controlling method defined by the feature [3], in the determining, the determination is made based on whether or not the value of the ratio of the integral intensity of the fluorescence spectrum to the integral intensity of the peak assigned to C—H stretching vibration in the Raman spectrum is not less than 82 when the resin composition comprises silicone resin particles and the TiO.sub.2 particles are anatase type.

(95) According to the feature [9], in the resin composition quality controlling method defined by the feature [3], in the determining, the determination is made based on whether or not the value of the ratio of the peak height of the fluorescence spectrum to the peak height of the peak assigned to C—H stretching vibration in the Raman spectrum is not less than 2.6 when the resin composition comprises silicone resin particles and the TiO.sub.2 particles are anatase type.

(96) According to the feature [10], a cable and tube quality controlling method, includes: determining a concentration of the TiO.sub.2 particles **11a**, **11b** in an insulator **23**, **24**, **41**, **42**, **43** being provided on a cable **20** or a tube **40a**, **40b**, **40c** and comprising the resin composition **1a**, **1b** by the resin composition quality controlling method defined by any one of the features [1] to [9].

(97) According to the feature [11], a determination device configured to perform the determining in the resin composition quality controlling method **1a**, **1b** defined by any one of the features [1] to [9].

(98) According to the feature [12], an inspection system **50** includes: a Raman measurement device **58** configured to perform the measuring in the resin composition quality controlling method defined by any one of the features [1] to [9]; and a determination device configured to perform the

determining in the resin composition quality controlling method **1a**, **1b** defined by any one of the features [1] to [9].

(99) According to the feature [13], a cable **20** or a tube **40a**, **40b**, **40c**, includes: an insulator **23**, **24**, **41**, **42**, **43** comprising a resin composition **1a**, **1b** comprising TiO.sub.2 particles **11a**, **11b** dispersed in a base material **10a**, **10b** comprising mainly a silicone rubber, wherein a concentration of the TiO.sub.2 particles **11a**, **11b** in the insulator **23**, **24**, **41**, **42**, **43** is within a range of 3.4 to 8.1 mass %.

(100) Although the embodiments of the invention have been described, the invention according to claims is not to be limited to the embodiments described above, and the various kinds of modifications can be implemented without departing from the gist of the invention. In addition, the invention according to claims is not to be limited to the above-mentioned embodiments. Further, please note that not all combinations of the features described in the embodiments are necessary to solve the problem of the invention.

Claims

1. A resin composition quality controlling method, comprising: measuring a Raman spectrum of a resin composition comprising TiO.sub.2 particles dispersed in a base material comprising mainly a silicone rubber by irradiating the resin composition with laser; and determining a concentration of the TiO.sub.2 particles in the resin composition based on an intensity of a fluorescence spectrum in the Raman spectrum.
2. The method according to claim 1, wherein in the determining, determination of whether or not the concentration of the TiO.sub.2 particles in the resin composition is within a range of 3.4 to 8.1 mass % is made.
3. The method according to claim 2, wherein in the determining, the determination is made based on a value of a ratio of the intensity of the fluorescence spectrum to an intensity of a peak assigned to C—H stretching vibration in the Raman spectrum.
4. The method according to claim 3, wherein in the determining, the determination is made based on whether or not a value of a ratio of an integral intensity of the fluorescence spectrum to an integral intensity of the peak assigned to C—H stretching vibration in the Raman spectrum is not less than 30.5 when the TiO.sub.2 particles are rutile type.
5. The method according to claim 3, wherein in the determining, the determination is made based on whether or not a value of a ratio of a peak height of the fluorescence spectrum to a peak height of the peak assigned to C—H stretching vibration in the Raman spectrum is not less than 0.89 when the TiO.sub.2 particles are rutile type.
6. The method according to claim 3, wherein in the determining, the determination is made based on whether or not the value of the ratio of the integral intensity of the fluorescence spectrum to the integral intensity of the peak assigned to C—H stretching vibration in the Raman spectrum is not less than 36.5 when the TiO.sub.2 particles are anatase type.
7. The method according to claim 3, wherein in the determining, the determination is made based on whether or not the value of the ratio of the peak height of the fluorescence spectrum to the peak height of the peak assigned to C—H stretching vibration in the Raman spectrum is not less than 1.0 when the TiO.sub.2 particles are anatase type.
8. The method according to claim 3, wherein in the determining, the determination is made based on whether or not the value of the ratio of the integral intensity of the fluorescence spectrum to the integral intensity of the peak assigned to C—H stretching vibration in the Raman spectrum is not less than 82 when the resin composition comprises silicone resin particles and the TiO.sub.2 particles are anatase type.
9. The method according to claim 3, wherein in the determining, the determination is made based on whether or not the value of the ratio of the peak height of the fluorescence spectrum to the peak

height of the peak assigned to C—H stretching vibration in the Raman spectrum is not less than 2.6 when the resin composition comprises silicone resin particles and the TiO₂ particles are anatase type.

10. A cable and tube quality controlling method, comprising: determining a concentration of the TiO₂ particles in an insulator being provided on a cable or a tube and comprising the resin composition by the resin composition quality controlling method according to claim 1.

11. A determination device configured to perform the determining in the resin composition quality controlling method according to claim 1.

12. An inspection system, comprising: a Raman measurement device configured to perform the measuring in the resin composition quality controlling method according to claim 1.

13. An inspection system, comprising: a determination device configured to perform the determining in the resin composition quality controlling method according to claim 1.
